

5.b) Historical Linguistics

Historical linguistics is a branch of linguistic Anthropology that studies origin of language.

Scope

- 1) emergence of language in general
- 2) how specific language has changed over time
- 3) identifying historical connection between languages.

It was founded by William Jones when he established Asiatic society of Bengal to study and translate Indian literature.

Techniques:

- 1) Glottochronology: analysing similarities and differences in vocabularies to determine approximate date of divergence of two languages.